THE POPIT & POD COMPUTER

An expanded visual and functional atlas of LittleBigPlanet interfaces

Visual design • functional inventory • platform differences • contextual restrictions • historical service limitations

Research synthesis and reference document

Prepared 29 October 2026 | Scope: major released LittleBigPlanet Popit and hub-interface variants

Method note: this document compares reported behavior, available screenshots, official announcements and specialist community documentation. It distinguishes documented facts from careful interpretation; exact icon placement can vary by mode, patch, region and selected player color.

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Terminology used below: "refusal" means an intentional restriction, unavailable action, context-dependent command, or post-service-shutdown dead end. It does not imply the game presents a literal refusal dialog.

1. Executive findings

LittleBigPlanet's interface is best understood as a family of related tools, not one static menu. The Popit is the player-facing command surface; the Popit Cursor is the object-manipulation instrument inside Create Mode; tweak menus expose parameters for a selected object; the Start/Pause Menu controls the level/session; and the Pod Computer is the hub through which players move among Play, Create, Community, profile and store destinations. Confusing these layers makes version comparisons unreliable. [1][2][9][19]

- The original PS3 Popit establishes the series' central metaphor: a menu that "pops" into the 2.5D world near the Sackperson, with soft, glossy panels, tactile iconography and a player-color identity. Creation, dressing, stickers and retry are presented as tools belonging to the character rather than as a detached conventional pause screen. [1][2]
- LittleBigPlanet 2 is the clearest broad visual redesign. Specialist documentation describes the old glossy/static-icon style giving way to a flatter, more saturated interface with animated icons and button hints in player-color-matched boxes. At the same time, Create Mode becomes a wider game-making system, and the UI reflects that shift with more tools, better selection operations and global controls separated from the old Tools Bag. [3][9][10]
- The PSP release is a genuine sibling implementation, not simply a reduced-resolution PS3 menu. It retains the recognizable Popit categories and Create Mode vocabulary, but reworks navigation and tutorials for a one-analog-stick portable system and introduces its own campaign/content structure. The official PlayStation Blog explicitly frames it as a new adventure adapted from the console experience. [4][5]

- LittleBigPlanet PS Vita adapts both appearance and interaction to the handheld. Community documentation records a green default Popit palette, a vertically adapted Pod with no side windows, touch-specific materials, a smaller thermometer and Create Mode control substitutions. The rear touch surface changes camera manipulation; these are interaction-model changes, not merely cosmetic skinning. [6][7][8]
- LittleBigPlanet Karting reuses the Popit concept but redefines what creation means. Character and kart customization sit beside track/arena construction, terrain cleanup, path editing, HUD placement and world controls. The menu's vocabulary changes because the authored artifact is now a racing course or battle arena, not only a platform level. [13][14]
- LittleBigPlanet 3 adds new capability to object inspection and character/asset authoring, including named hover information, object-information bubbles, signal inspection for switches, captured characters and Sackpocket items, and a 16-layer system. Its separate Pod Computer underwent a second major change in August 2016, when its multi-planet navigation was replaced by a single transforming destination view with clearer Play/Create/Community/profile/store paths. [10][15][16][17]
- "Missing" does not always mean "removed." Some controls are intentionally mode-limited, some move to a different category, some become platform-specific replacements, and some remain represented in menus after official online services have shut down. These cases must be classified separately. [6][9][15][18]

2. Scope, terms and evidence standard

2.1 Releases covered

The core comparison covers the major released variants with a recognizable Popit or closely related creation interface: LittleBigPlanet on PS3; LittleBigPlanet on PSP; LittleBigPlanet 2; LittleBigPlanet PS Vita; LittleBigPlanet Karting; and LittleBigPlanet 3 on PS3/PS4, including its later Pod Computer redesign. This covers the meaningful evolution of the Popit and the hub UI across the main family of games and its prominent creation-focused spin-off. [4][7][13][16]

This is not a catalog of every downloadable costume, level-pack-specific gadget, localization, prototype, patch icon, cut feature, or later Sackboy-branded game. The unreleased LittleBigPlanet HUB and prototype menus are discussed only as boundary cases, not treated as shippable versions. Likewise, Sackboy: A Big Adventure and mobile runner titles do not use the same creation-centered Popit system and are outside the comparison.

2.2 What "Popit computer UI" means here

Players and fan discussions sometimes use "Popit," "Popit computer," and "Pod Computer" loosely. This document uses "Popit" for the menu opened during play, "Pod Computer" for the in-hub navigation device/menu, and "Pod Popit" for the Popit variant available while physically inside the Pod. This is important because the Popit's in-level functions and the Pod Computer's destinations have separate histories. In LittleBigPlanet 3, the Pod Computer can change the player's navigation experience while the Popit itself remains the creation/customization interface. [2][15][19]

2.3 Evidence standard

Label	Meaning	How it is used
Documented	A feature, appearance or date is directly described by an official source, a game manual/guide, or a specialist reference that identifies the title/version.	Core claims and cross-version deltas.
Corroborated	A specialist wiki and an independent screenshot/guide support the same conclusion.	Visual styling and operational details where formal manuals are incomplete.
Qualified	Evidence is fragmentary, version-specific or sourced from a fan-maintained article marked as incomplete.	Claims are explicitly attributed and not overstated.

Label	Meaning	How it is used
Not asserted	There is no reliable basis here to claim a precise behavior.	No invented icon positions, exact animation timings, or undocumented refusals.

Fan-maintained technical references are useful for command-level detail but may be incomplete or revised. The report therefore treats them as specialist documentation, not as official developer specifications. An official PlayStation Blog post is preferred for announced product and hub changes; specialist wikis are used for precise control behavior and inventories. [2][4][10][15]

3. The interface system: five layers that should not be conflated

Layer	Where it appears	Primary responsibility	Common comparison mistake
Popit menu	During gameplay, and in some Pod contexts	Character customization, stickers/decorations, retry and access to creation tools.	Calling every menu that appears near the character a Pod Computer.
Popit Cursor	Create Mode, accessed through the Popit toolset	Select, place, move, scale, rotate, duplicate, glue, detach, delete and inspect items.	Treating the cursor as merely a pointer rather than the core editor.
Tweak/context menu	When a tweakable object/tool is selected or highlighted	Expose properties of that particular object: behavior, appearance, logic, physics or other parameters.	Comparing the number of Popit menu icons as though it equals the number of edit actions.
Start/Pause Menu	Gameplay and Create Mode	Restart/return, save/save-as, switching modes, view, grid/snap and level information.	Attributing save and view settings to the Popit even when they belong to Start.
Pod Computer / hub UI	Inside the Pod/hub	Navigate Play, Create, Community, profile, store and related destinations.	Mistaking a Community/planet navigation redesign for a redesign of the in-level Popit.

3.1 Popit as a spatial menu

The early design makes the menu feel attached to the Sackperson and the craft-world. Its panels and cursor are integrated with the play space, so a player can move from expression/costume changes to stickers and then to object creation without leaving the fiction of the game. The official licensed guide describes the Popit as appearing above the Sackperson when the Square button is pressed, and character customization is navigated with the left stick. [1]

3.2 Popit Cursor as editor, not just launcher

Once an item is selected, it can become a translucent placement preview; confirming places it. The cursor can then select objects in the world and offers move/scale/rotate and layer operations. In later titles, selection lists, object hiding, hover name bubbles and richer inspection commands build upon that original model. [10]

3.3 Pod Computer as world map and content browser

The Pod Computer is diegetic: the player is in a crafted Pod with a computer-like destination selector, while the destinations are framed as places in the Imagisphere. Its evolution is largely a navigation and information-architecture story. The 2016 LittleBigPlanet 3 redesign explicitly replaced a multi-planet structure with a single planet view that transforms as the player moves between destinations. The official announcement says older functions were still available with an additional button action inside each planet/category. [15]

4. Persistent design language and input grammar

4.1 Icon-and-page structure

Across releases, a stable pattern remains: category icons lead to paged inventories; selected items are highlighted; left/right or on-screen arrows and page indicators communicate that an inventory continues; a confirm action selects or places; a back/cancel action returns one level or closes the menu. The precise panel count and style change, but the inventory pattern persists. The PSP introduction tutorial even teaches players to use shoulder/page buttons to move quickly between customization pages. [5]

4.2 Player color is a functional UI token

Player color is not only avatar decoration. It affects the Popit and related UI, and the color system is reworked between titles. In the original PS3 release, the palette uses primary, secondary and tertiary colors for menu backgrounds, highlights and tutorial notifications. LittleBigPlanet 2 introduces a changed set and a fourth emphasis color, with changed roles for the colors. LittleBigPlanet PS Vita adapts the LBP2 palette, and LBP3 reuses/extends palettes to 24 while changing how colors are assigned to menu backgrounds, highlights and accents. As a result, “blue Popit” versus “green Popit” can refer to default/platform presentation, not to a single invariant color code. [8]

Visual token	Early PS3 presentation	Later observed change	Practical meaning
Panel material	Glossy, rounded and soft/translucent in the classic presentation.	LBP2 moves toward flatter, brighter, more color-blocked UI.	The look shifts from tactile glass to a more legible graphic system. [3]
Icons	Mostly static category/tool imagery in the early style.	LBP2 uses animated icons, according to specialist documentation.	Selection feels more active; a highlighted icon carries more motion feedback. [3]
Button hints	Cloud-like/soft hint shapes with dark text in the original style.	LBP2 places prompts in smooth boxes keyed to the player’s chosen color.	Input help becomes more visually tied to player identity. [3]
Selection color	The player palette indicates focus/ownership.	Palette roles and available hues change from game to game.	Do not compare color alone without matching title and player-color setting. [8]
Hover feedback	Cursor highlight communicates an interactable object.	LBP2+ adds hover-name bubbles; LBP3 adds richer information bubbles.	Later Popit is also an inspection/debugging surface. [10]

4.3 Button prompts are context, not a universal map

The same physical action can be interpreted differently depending on mode: the Popit button opens the Popit or a tweak menu; the selection action can place a preview, select an existing object or confirm a category; and the Start/Options menu manages the level/session. A reliable recreation or analysis should index prompts by game + mode + selected object, not simply by button name. The Popit Cursor reference lists cross-title differences and notes that some features begin only in LittleBigPlanet 2 or later. [10]

4.4 Tactile fiction versus editor clarity

The UI tries to preserve the sewn-paper, toy-like world while exposing increasingly technical operations. LBP2’s flatter iconography and redesigned gadgets show the move toward consistency and readability; LBP3’s infobubbles and switch-output oscilloscope show that the same interface had also become a more diagnostic authoring tool. [3][10]

5. Version-by-version comparison

5.1 LittleBigPlanet (PS3, 2008): the foundational Popit

The original Popit is the baseline for later titles. Its interaction is immediate and spatial: Square opens the menu above the Sackperson, with the left stick browsing icons and the action button selecting. The licensed guide describes the menu as the primary path to customization and creation, with character wardrobe pages for materials, garments, colors and saved ensembles. [1]

Visual design

- The visual language is soft and glossy rather than flat: rounded panel shapes, translucent/glass-like surfaces and a gentle, tactile feel are characteristic of the early menu. [3]
- The menu's accent/highlight behavior is driven by the selected player palette. It is therefore both a menu and a multiplayer identity cue. [8]
- Control help uses a softer cloud-styled visual treatment in the early version; LBP2 later replaces this with color-matched prompt boxes. [3]
- The design carries the craft-world metaphor into practical editing: the cursor, materials and stickers are shown as tangible things to pick up and manipulate, rather than generic software command rows. [1][2]

Functional inventory

Element	What it does	Version-specific notes / boundaries
Customize Character	Browse and wear collected costumes, materials, body-related options and saved outfits.	The first game's character customization teaches the page-based inventory pattern. Exact subpages depend on unlocks/content. [1]
Stickers & Decorations	Choose a collected decal/decorative asset and apply it to eligible surfaces.	Sticker placement is separate from Create Mode object manipulation; it is not a universal "place any object" action. [1]
Goodies Bag	Select collected materials/objects and use them in a level.	The library contains collected and available assets; it is not an unrestricted external file browser. [9][11]
Tools Bag	Select creation tools and level-authoring objects.	In LBP1, global level settings are not yet a separate Popit section; later games organize these as Global Stuff. [9]
Tutorials	Jump into the next available Create Mode lesson/tutorial flow.	The Popit Tutorials icon is specific to LBP1 and LBP2; in LBP1 it takes the player to the Tutorial Moon/next lesson. [2][9]
Retry / Hold to Retry	Respawn at the last activated checkpoint after a sustained confirm input.	This is a checkpoint recovery shortcut, not a save or full-level restart command. [2]
Popit Cursor	Place/select/transform objects in Create Mode.	Selection and object-editing operations are central but the later selection-list and inspection aids have not yet been added. [10]

Constraints and interpretation

The original interface has fewer explicitly separated top-level categories because the game's design brief centers on platforming, sticker-based expression and level crafting. Global controls and tutorials are less separated than in later editions. This should be read as an early, simpler information architecture, not as evidence that the engine has no world-level controls. [9]

5.2 LittleBigPlanet (PSP, 2009): portable sibling, reworked navigation

The PSP version retains the Popit identity but is built around a portable screen and input layout. PlayStation's 2009 blog described the transition from the PS3 screen to PSP as a new way of interacting with Sackpeople and framed the title as a new adventure, not only a port. The same official post describes the Popit as the place to change clothing, apply stickers and enter Create Mode's tool inventory. [4]

Core six-menu Create Mode structure

Menu / affordance	Role	Boundary
Popit Cursor	Select and manipulate level objects/tools.	Only meaningful as an editor tool in Create Mode. [12]
Stickers	Apply collected stickers to surfaces.	Placement and transform interaction is adapted to PSP's single analog nub plus face/shoulder controls. [5]
Goodies Bag	Browse materials and objects used for a level.	Only present for creation; the PSP does not expose every console-specific creation feature. [12]
Customize Character	Browse and apply clothing/looks.	Page buttons support faster wardrobe paging, as taught in the PSP tutorial text. [5]
Tools Bag	Access level-creation tools.	The available toolbox is the PSP build's own subset; do not assume every later gadget exists. [4][12]
Hold to Retry	Return to the last checkpoint.	It is a play-mode recovery affordance, not a Create Mode undo action. [12]

How the portable version differs

- The basic visual vocabulary is deliberately recognizable, but screen size and input hardware force a compact navigation model. The PSP tutorial explicitly explains icon browsing with the analog stick, action selection, Back-based unwinding, and page-button shortcuts for wardrobe pages. [5]
- The game's introduction tutorial replaces some in-level tutorial screens from the original with full-screen video buttons, another example of the portable build changing how help is presented rather than reproducing every PS3 presentation detail. [5][20]
- The April 2010 "Cherry Pie" update added or improved Create Mode behaviors such as flipping objects and Front View, which removes perspective for precision. These are editor usability changes, not changes to the basic Popit metaphor. [21]
- The PSP version's six-menu list documented in the PSP community wiki resembles the early PS3 structure, but it should not be read as proof of identical item inventory or identical underlying controls. The title's version, platform and content differ. [12]

Constraints and refusals

The PSP Popit is limited by a different button/stick layout and the content implemented in the PSP branch. Some functions familiar from later entries—especially later control schemes, diagnostic popups and LBP3-specific character/power-up systems—should not be projected backward onto it. This is a compatibility boundary, not a hidden toggle. The sources reviewed support the category-level comparison but do not provide enough reliable evidence to claim an exhaustive icon-by-icon PSP-to-PS3 pixel diff.

5.3 LittleBigPlanet 2 (PS3, 2011): the major visual and editorial overhaul

LittleBigPlanet 2 keeps the earlier game's core interaction model, but expands the project from a platform editor into a more general game-creation platform. Its Popit is not simply recolored: the menu and the gadget ecosystem become more graphic, consistent and legible. [3][16]

Visual differences from LBP1

- The earlier glossy, smooth menu gives way to a flatter and more vibrant palette, with animated icons. [3]
- Button instructions are set inside smooth boxes colored to match the selected Popit palette, replacing the cloud-styled prompt treatment described for the original game. [3]
- Gadgets move toward a common design language: many are represented as white-plated, black-screen devices with distinctive flat icons. The specialist reference notes that sensors resemble irises, World Tweakers are circular and Object Tweakers use an eight-pointed star form. [3]
- The Create Mode background is updated to parallelogram-like tiles and the overall game image is described as slightly brighter because shading is reduced. This is adjacent visual context, not a Popit-panel change, but it affects how the menu reads over the editor. [3]

Functional additions / changes

Element	LBP2 change	Why it matters
Personal	Provides access to hearted/favorited usable content; in some builds/settings also surfaces items already being used in a creation.	A shortcut layer over inventory, distinct from the entire Goodies Bag. [19]
Tutorials	Selecting the tutorial entry takes the player to a tutorial page rather than teleporting to the next lesson on the Tutorial Moon.	A small but clear change in information architecture. [2][9]
Global Stuff	Global level settings are separated from the Tools Bag.	The editor distinguishes world-wide settings from tools/gadgets placed into the world. [9]
Popit Cursor selection list	Holding R2 while selecting lets the player assemble a multi-object selection list.	Batch editing becomes easier in denser levels. [10]
Hide/reveal objects	L2 can make hovered objects transparent; L1 reveals hidden objects again.	Makes overlapping construction more manageable. [10]
Hover name bubble	Hovering displays the object's name.	More feedback, but invalid names could trigger a return-to-Pod bug in some cases. [10]
Gadget inventory	Gadgets are redesigned and the authoring toolset becomes broader.	The same Popit structure now supports logic, behavior and non-platform genres. [3][16]

Limits and caveats

The visual overhaul does not mean that all old behavior vanishes. LBP2 was built from the first game and retained nearly all legacy features with modifications, while retiring or relocating selected functions. An accurate comparison should say "moved," "reorganized," or "redesigned" where functionality persists, rather than labeling every altered category as a removal. [16]

5.4 LittleBigPlanet PS Vita (2012): touch-aware handheld adaptation

The Vita version is especially valuable when distinguishing visual changes from input changes. Community documentation records the Pod as vertically stretched for the handheld screen, without the left/right side windows found in the console Pod; the DualShock controller presentation is replaced by the Vita system itself. The default Popit color is reported as green rather than blue. [6]

Interaction changes

Element	Vita-specific behavior	Effect on the user experience
Touch materials	Materials are added to take advantage of Vita touch input/touch-pad capabilities.	The editor supports physical touchscreen interaction concepts, not just analog-stick cursor movement. [6][7]
Camera control	The right stick is used alongside the rear touch pad for camera movement/control.	The editor's camera grammar changes to exploit both front/rear input surfaces. [6]

Element	Vita-specific behavior	Effect on the user experience
Thermometer	Reportedly somewhat smaller, including its HUD presentation, because of hardware constraints.	Less screen space is spent on construction budget feedback. [6]
Create Mode controls	“Gameplay Controls” and “Global Controls” replace Text Chat and Retry in the cited Create Mode context.	The editor prioritizes control reference/global settings over two general play/social shortcuts in that context. [6]
Pod frame	Vertically adapted Pod; no side windows.	The diegetic hub is re-framed to fit the Vita screen. [6]
Object information	User-made object names are shown in hover information, unlike earlier behavior that primarily surfaced developer item names.	Community content is easier to identify from the cursor. [10]

What is inherited, what is new

Vita retains the familiar Popit, cursor, materials, stickers and inventory framework, but the handheld’s touch surfaces enable a new interaction vocabulary. The title’s specialist overview explicitly notes that some material-tweaking, touchpad and tool changes later made their way to LittleBigPlanet 3. [7] That inheritance should be described as design/tool influence, not proof that LBP3 copied every Vita input path.

Restrictions

Specialist documentation says online play is unavailable while creating in LBP Vita. It also describes hardware-linked constraints such as the smaller thermometer. Those limitations differ from post-2024 service shutdowns: the former are part of the Vita build’s original design; the latter concern service availability after release. [6][18]

5.5 LittleBigPlanet Karting (2012): Popit becomes a racing-course editor

LittleBigPlanet Karting carries over the familiar Popit pattern, but the authored object is primarily a race track or battle arena. The Popit Computer’s “Me” path leads toward the player’s Moon and Earth, and the guide describes the Moon as the home for unpublished levels while the Earth is the place for published creations. The hub can also expose tutorials, profile activity and decoration for the player’s worlds. [13]

Major Popit categories and functions

Category	Included functions documented for Karting	Purpose / scope
Character customization	Reset Costume; Random Costume; Save Costume; Wash Costume.	Dress, randomize, preserve or clear the character outfit. [14]
Kart customization	Reset Kart; Random Kart; Save Kart; Wash Kart.	Parallel customization workflow for the vehicle, a central racing-game identity. [14]
Stickers & Decorations	Sticker & Decoration Edit Tool; Take Photo; Delete All Community Photos.	Decorate the scene and manage community-derived photos. [14]
Objects	Popit Cursor; Material Changer; Sticker Template; UV Tool; Capture Object; Grouping Tool; Draw Path; Edit Path Tool; HUD Cursor; Delete All Community Objects.	The general purpose object toolbox plus path/UV/HUD-specific editing. [14]
Track & Arena Edit	Create Track; Create Arena; Branches; Re-Roll; Horizontal Shift; Vertical Shift; Add/Remove Control Points; Breadcrumbs.	Build, reshape and edit racing or battle spaces. [14]
Terrain Edit	Terrain Clean-up.	Repair or tidy the course’s terrain representation. [14]
Global Controls	Water Level; Clear All; Clear Objects; Clear Terrain; Clear Track/Arena; Karts.	Global or destructive operations over major parts of the authored level. [14]

Visual/functional meaning

- The toolset makes track authoring a first-class workflow: paths, branches and control points are not just object decorations; they determine route geometry and how a course plays. [13][14]
- The HUD Cursor is an important divergence from platform-focused versions because racing experiences depend on placing or editing race-specific display elements. [14]
- Character and kart customization use parallel “reset/random/save/wash” actions. This is a stronger two-object customization structure than the earlier wardrobe-only focus. [14]
- Global controls include several broad clear operations. Their destructive scope is wider than a normal placement tool, so they must be treated as context-sensitive actions, not generic “undo” operations. [14]

Restrictions and caution

Some functions in the catalog are marked “unreleased” by the specialist reference (for example, Auto Populate, Loop, Corkscrew and Place Along Track). These should not be presented as shipped Popit controls merely because they appear in a technical inventory. The list also contains track- or arena-specific tools that have no direct one-to-one equivalent in a platform-level editor. [14]

5.6 LittleBigPlanet 3 at launch (PS3/PS4, 2014): diagnostics and broader authoring

LittleBigPlanet 3 is the last mainline release on PS3 and the first on PS4. It introduces OddSock, Toggle and Swoop; custom characters and powerups; tools for multilevel adventures; and an increase from three to sixteen layers. The overall creative system still maintains compatibility with earlier user-generated content, while the interface expands to support the new character and logic systems. [16]

Popit Cursor and object inspection

- Hover-name bubbles continue from LBP2, but LBP3 adds a richer info bubble, documented as showing information such as object weight and layer range. [10]
- When hovering over the output of a switch, L2 can open an oscilloscope-style display that shows its output signal. That is a diagnostic interface for logic, not an ordinary decoration action. [10]
- LBP3 includes capture tools for characters and Sackpocket items in its Popit Functions inventory. These broaden the authoring objects beyond a conventional material/sticker/prop library. [10]
- The expanded layer limit makes layer-management controls more consequential; moving objects forward/backward through layers remains part of the cursor grammar. [10][16]

Pod-only character selection

A Characters feature is available from the Popit while inside the Pod in LBP3, allowing the player to change among Sackboy, OddSock, Toggle and Swoop. The change applies to the Pod context and does not, by itself, force the selected character for a level. This is an important “scope of effect” rule: a visible avatar selector is not the same as a global game-character override. [19]

The Sackpocket is related, but not the Popit

LBP3 adds the Sackpocket, an Adventure-wide inventory for up to five unique powerups. It is a separate radial menu, opened by Circle in the documented PS3/PS4 control scheme, and a selected powerup is equipped from its slot. Only Sackboy can access and use the inventory, even though other playable characters can collect items into it. Do not label this as another Popit page: it is a neighboring in-game radial interface with a different purpose and control binding. [17]

Limitations

Not every menu option works in every mode. The Retry option is not available in Create Mode in LBP3; that does not imply retry is globally removed from the game. Some legacy gadgets or assets can also behave differently across titles and updates. [19][16]

5.7 LittleBigPlanet 3 after the 2016 Pod Computer redesign

On 15 August 2016, the official PlayStation Blog announced a major LBP3 Community UI redesign. The key change was the navigation model: gone was the multi-planet structure; instead, a single planet view morphs into destinations as the player scrolls through the Pod Computer. The post states that prior functionality remained accessible inside each planet/category with a quick X-button action. [15]

New high-level destinations

Destination	What it surfaces	How navigation changed
Play	Adventure, Popit Puzzles and purchased More Stories level kits.	The primary play destination remains largely unchanged, according to the announcement. [15]
Create	The Moon with saved creations; decoration of Earth and Moon; the full range of tutorials.	Creation and owned worlds are gathered under an explicit destination. [15]
Community	Level of the Day, Recommended For You, Team Picks, Busiest levels and recently published creations.	L1/R1 cycles featured filters; X opens the fuller traditional Community Menu. [15]
All About Me	Avatar/profile description, profile comments, pins and hints for near-earned pins.	Profile management becomes its own destination instead of being spread among planet views. [15]
Store	Level kits, costumes and add-ons.	Purchase and content acquisition are surfaced as an explicit top-level category. [15]
Friends / Dive In	Online friends, joining/inviting to a Pod, visiting their worlds/profiles, or Dive In discovery when appropriate.	Social presence is surfaced at the bottom of the interface; L1/R1 browses friends. [15]
Recent Activity filters	More adjustable filters for activity/content, with selections saved between sessions.	Search/discovery can be personalized and persist across play sessions. [15]

What did not change

This is chiefly a Pod Computer and Community information-architecture redesign, not evidence that the in-level Popit was entirely replaced. The official post explicitly says the former functionality remains available. It does, however, change the amount of work needed to reach common destinations and foregrounds discovery and social routes. [15]

Current-service caveat

These are descriptions of the intended UI when services operated. Sony's current support documentation says LBP3's PS4 servers were taken offline indefinitely after ongoing technical issues; all online services, including access to other players' creations, are no longer available. Local content and offline campaign features remain accessible. Thus the 2016 Community, friends, Dive In, online publishing and remote-community flows may still be represented in the historical UI but cannot be assumed operational on official servers today. [18]

6. Element-by-element Popit inventory

This section compares each high-level element by function and by the most meaningful version differences. Specific sub-pages and DLC inventory vary with the player's unlocks, installed content, mode, and title; the inventory below describes the stable role of each element rather than pretending each game exposes an identical number of pages.

6.1 Customize Character

Function: a wardrobe/inventory for collected costume pieces, materials, colors and saved ensembles. It is player-facing and generally available outside Create Mode. The early licensed guide describes browsing garments, materials and colors; the PSP tutorial adds page-button shortcuts; later games add structured reset/random/save/wash actions and LBP3 adds Pod-only character selection among its playable cast. [1][5][10][14][19]

Visual change: the early soft/glossy panel gives way in LBP2 to brighter, flatter menu chrome and animated icons. Later panels can be more modular and content-heavy. The basic metaphor remains a curated wardrobe rather than an external asset manager. [3]

Constraints/refusals: the interface only exposes acquired/available costume parts and installed content. A character chosen in the LBP3 Pod is not automatically a global override for every playable level. Karting's parallel kart customization is specific to the racing branch and should not be imported into LBP1/2 wardrobe descriptions. [14][19]

6.2 Stickers & Decorations

Function: browse and apply collected stickers and decorations, and in later versions use supporting editing tools such as sticker/decal editing, sticker cutter/scrubber, Paint, photography or community-photo management. These are separate from material placement and from the general Popit Cursor. [1][10][11]

Visual and functional delta: the category persists while its tool list broadens. LBP2 introduces the Paint tool and additional sticker tools; LBP3's inventory lists sticker cutter, scrubber and Paint among the available creation functions; Karting adds taking photos and deleting all community photos. [10][14]

Constraints/refusals: a sticker is not necessarily a physical material or a general-purpose object. Its placement depends on target surface/context; the existence of an editing function in one release does not make it available in earlier games. Destructive bulk commands such as deleting community photos should be treated separately from routine placement. [10][14]

6.3 Personal

Function: a shortcut collection of content the player has hearted/marked for convenient access; it is not synonymous with the full Goodies Bag. The exact contents depend on what has been hearted and on the current mode, and Create Mode may expose assets that are already being used in the current level. [19]

Visual purpose: reduces repeated browsing through long category inventories by adding a personal/relevance layer on top of the same underlying assets. It is a navigation shortcut, not a separate asset format.

Constraints/refusals: content not owned, not installed, or not made available in that context should not be assumed to be selectable merely because Personal exists. This report avoids claiming one identical Personal page layout across every release.

6.4 Hold to Retry / Retry

Function: hold the confirm button long enough to respawn at the last activated checkpoint. It is a convenience action for Play Mode, not the same as restarting from the beginning through Start/Pause. [2]

Cross-title difference: the function is listed among the stable Popit features, but the cited comparison notes that Retry is not available in Create Mode in LBP3. On Vita, Create Mode has a different control set—Gameplay Controls and Global Controls instead of Text Chat and Retry, according to the specialist version-differences page. [6][19]

Refusal taxonomy: an absent Retry icon in Create Mode is a context rule; an inability to access community content after server shutdown is a service issue; neither should be described as a broken checkpoint function.

6.5 Popit Cursor

Function: the central creation tool. A selected inventory item appears translucent as a preview; confirm places it. The cursor can select existing objects, box-select, duplicate, move, scale, rotate, flip, change layer, detach/delete, glue, and open tweak menus for supported objects. [10]

Evolution highlights: LBP2+ adds multi-object selection lists via R2 and hide/reveal behavior; LBP2+ adds name bubbles; Vita displays names for user-created objects; LBP3 adds detail bubbles with object information and an oscilloscope for switch output. [10]

Refusals and hidden constraints: not every object is tweakable; only compatible objects can be glued; layering and valid layer ranges constrain movement; bulk deletion is distinct from detaching; and the selection/camera mapping varies by platform. In the original game, an edge case described by the specialist documentation allows a placement

during layer-changing to enter normally invalid layers, after which selecting the object snaps it back into a valid layer. That is a historical behavior/edge case, not a recommended workflow. [10]

6.6 Goodies Bag

Function: the asset library for materials and objects, including objects collected in story levels, level packs, community levels, and saved/captured objects. It is the inventory source; the Popit Cursor is the tool used to place an item in the level. [11]

Version differences: the name and basic job persist, but available sub-categories and item types expand with each toolset. LBP3's capture character and capture Sackpocket item tools extend the scope of what can be created as reusable assets. Karting includes object-oriented utilities such as UV Tool, grouping, path editor and HUD cursor beside the familiar material/object workflow. [10][14]

Refusals: it is not a general filesystem. The bag exposes the content the game has made available to the player, including collected and installed content; the available object types and actions are release-specific. [11]

6.7 Tools Bag

Function: tools, gameplay objects, gadgets and Popit functions for authoring behavior and interactions. In LBP2, the breadth of gadgets supports game genres beyond platforming and the gadget designs are brought into a more consistent visual family. [3][12][16]

Organizational difference: Global Stuff is separated into its own category in later games; LBP1 originally houses many world-level settings in the Tools Bag. Therefore an item missing from the LBP1 Tools Bag may have been reorganized, rather than deleted, in a later build. [9]

6.8 Global Stuff / Global Controls

Function: alter level-wide environmental/state settings such as lighting, water level and background; later versions may add additional global actions depending on the game. [9]

Version changes: the category is described as present in PS Vita, Karting and LBP3; the original places global settings among the tools. In Vita, "Global Controls" is also named as a Create Mode control entry; Karting's global area includes water level, clearing objects/terrain/track or arena and kart-related controls. [6][9][14]

Refusals: global controls are not the same as object tweak menus. A global "clear" action can have broad destructive scope; its availability depends on the content/mode being edited. A control may exist in one release under a different name or different level of the menu hierarchy.

6.9 Tutorials

Function: on-boarding and context help. In LBP1, the Popit Tutorials option routes to the next uncompleted Create Mode tutorial on the Tutorial Moon. In LBP2, the option opens a tutorials page. Later games can provide tutorials from the Pod Create area and, in Karting, the tutorial library can also be accessed through the hub or from a specific selected tool if a tutorial video exists. [2][9][13]

Refusals: the Popit Tutorials icon is documented as exclusive to LBP1 and LBP2. Its absence in later Popit menus is not proof that tutorials are absent from those games; they are relocated into other hub or context-help paths. [2][13]

6.10 Pod Decoration / Planet Decoration

Function: apply stickers and decorations to the Pod and save/reset its customized appearance; later entries also expose planet/Earth/Moon decoration. The Save Pod tool captures the Pod's decoration state into a reusable saved-Pod inventory. [10][15][22]

Constraints: Pod decoration controls are available only in the Pod context and, according to the specialist reference, only when standing in the Pod and not engaged with the Pod Computer. It is a spatial/context requirement rather than a missing general menu option. [22]

6.11 LBP3 Sackpocket (related, not identical)

Function: a five-slot Adventure-wide power-up inventory, represented as a radial menu. Circle opens/closes it; the left stick moves the highlight among occupied slots and confirm equips the chosen item. [17]

Restrictions: only Sackboy can access/use stored items, even though other characters can collect items for the inventory. This is a clear example of a UI whose availability follows character/state rules. It should not be confused with the Square-button Popit menu. [17]

7. Pod Computer / hub UI inventory

7.1 Original hub model

The Pod and its computer present the player's creative world as destinations. My Moon is the private workbench for saved/unpublished levels; Earth is the share/published-world concept; Profile/My Profile surfaces activity and community feedback; Tutorials provides learning; and decoration lets players personalize the exterior of their world. The LittleBigPlanet Karting guide explicitly describes these roles and the "Me" path to the player's Moon and Earth. [13]

7.2 LBP2 and the broader hub-information architecture

LBP2 retires the InfoMoon and relocates some information such as news and personal statistics elsewhere, according to the specialist overview. This is another example of a navigation concept moving out of one hub object rather than being eliminated in principle. [16]

7.3 LBP3 2016 navigation model

The 2016 redesign groups the main hub into clearly named destinations: Play, Create, Community, All About Me and Store; social/friends entry points are surfaced at the bottom; Recent Activity gets persistent filters; and X can open the familiar deeper menu from the simplified Community destination. This reduces the need to navigate among multiple separate planets to reach common functions. [15]

7.4 Visual reference: Pod Computer is not the Popit

A globe surrounded by Community options in the Vita-era visual reference [23] represents hub/community navigation, not the in-level radial/hovering Popit. Likewise, the 2016 LBP3 update describes how the Pod Computer navigates destinations rather than the Popit Cursor's selection behavior. [15][23]

8. Restrictions, absent controls and failure cases

The word "refusal" can conceal several very different cases. For forensic comparison, use the following taxonomy.

Type	Meaning	Concrete LittleBigPlanet examples	Correct interpretation
Mode restriction	A function is intentionally unavailable in a particular mode.	Retry is not available in LBP3 Create Mode. [19]	The feature can still exist elsewhere in the same game.
Platform/input restriction	The platform changes or removes a control path.	Vita touch materials, combined right-stick/rear-touch camera, smaller thermometer. [6]	It is a deliberate adaptation to hardware, not a cosmetic change.
Relocation/renaming	The function persists but moves to a different category/screen.	Tutorial Moon shortcut becomes a tutorials page in LBP2; Global Stuff separated from Tools Bag. [2][9]	Record "moved" rather than "removed."
Content gating	Only unlocked/collected/installed items appear.	Goodies Bag and wardrobe inventory are based on acquired/available assets. [1][11]	Absence may reflect ownership or content state, not UI version.

Type	Meaning	Concrete LittleBigPlanet examples	Correct interpretation
Object compatibility	An action applies only to eligible objects.	Tweak menus require tweakable objects; gluing requires compatible spatial relationships. [10]	A disabled action may be correct for the selected object.
Destructive-scope guard	Bulk action affects more than one item.	Karting Global Controls includes Clear All/Clear Objects/Clear Terrain/Clear Track-Arena. [14]	Do not treat it as ordinary Delete or Undo.
Software defect / malformed content	The function exists but some input/content can trigger a bug.	LBP2+ hover-name bubbles are reported to have booted the player to the Pod if an item had an invalid name; LBP3 introduced a workaround after such items were hovered. [10]	Distinguish bug history from intentional UI policy.
Service shutdown	A remote service is unavailable even if the UI path remains.	Official LBP online services closed in stages; LBP3 PS4 servers were taken offline indefinitely in April 2024. [18][24]	The menu can remain visible while the online destination is unavailable.
Unreleased / development-only	A tool is known from data or technical pages but not a normal shipped feature.	Karting function index marks Auto Populate, Loop, Corkscrew and Place Along Track as unreleased; some LBP2 entries are marked DEV ONLY. [10][14]	Do not describe it as a normal retail control.

8.1 Current official-server reality (as of 29 October 2026)

Sony's decommissioned-server documentation states that LittleBigPlanet 3 PS4 online services are no longer available, including access to other players' creations; locally stored user-generated content and offline campaign features remain available. The PS3/Vita server closures occurred earlier. This is a material distinction for UI preservation: an archived screenshot can accurately show a button that no longer has a working official online destination. [18][24]

Community-run replacement servers exist for some editions, but they are not official Sony services and are outside the behavioral scope of this document. Their setup, status, security model and available feature coverage can change. The report does not imply that a visible official UI flow is currently functional through such services. [25]

9. Comparative matrices

9.1 Major release deltas

Release	Dominant visual change	Dominant functional change	Largest restriction / qualification
LBP (PS3)	Glossy, soft, tactile panels; player-color identity.	Foundational wardrobe, stickers, Goodies/Tools and object cursor.	Global settings less separated; tutorial shortcut routes to Tutorial Moon. [1][2][3]
LBP (PSP)	Portable-screen adaptation, familiar icon/category system.	Same six-menu Create Mode vocabulary, adapted controls and tutorial presentation.	Not a one-to-one port; dedicated content and input constraints. [4][5][12]
LBP2 (PS3)	Flat/brighter, animated icons; color-coded prompt boxes.	Selection lists, hide/reveal objects, hover names; broader gadgets/game creation.	Some legacy features relocated or revised, not simply retained unchanged. [3][10][16]
LBP PS Vita	Green default Popit; vertically adapted Pod.	Touch materials; rear touch and analog camera input; global/gameplay control entries.	Smaller thermometer; online Create Mode unavailable per specialist documentation. [6][7]
LBP Karting	Popit retained but organized around race-creation vocabulary.	Kart appearance, track/arena, paths, branches, terrain, HUD and global clear tools.	Several entries in technical lists are unreleased; track tools do not map one-to-one to platform tools. [13][14]

Release	Dominant visual change	Dominant functional change	Largest restriction / qualification
LBP3 (2014)	Evolved colorful Popit; richer contextual info.	Character/power-up capture, 16 layers, object info, logic-signal inspection.	Retry absent in Create Mode; Pod character selection is context-scoped. [10][16][17][19]
LBP3 (2016+ hub)	Single transforming destination/planet view replaces multi-planet navigation.	Play/Create/Community/All About Me/Store; friends/Dive In and persistent activity filters.	Official PS4 online services offline indefinitely since 2024. [15][18]

9.2 Which element changes most?

Element	Change level	Reason
Panel look, icon motion, prompt styling	High	Clear generational visual break from LBP1 to LBP2. [3]
Player-color system	Medium to high	Palette values and the roles of primary/secondary/tertiary colors change by game; LBP3 extends palettes. [8]
Popit Cursor fundamentals	Low at the conceptual level; high in capability	Selection/placement persists, while selection lists, hiding and inspection arrive later. [10]
Wardrobe / stickers	Low at the top-level concept; medium in supporting tools	The categories persist, but editing tools and types of reusable content expand. [10][14]
Create inventory / toolset	High	LBP2 broadens the design platform, Vita adds touch-aware functions, Karting specializes on tracks, and LBP3 adds capture/logic/character systems. [3][7][14][16]
Pod Computer navigation	High in LBP3 2016	The hierarchy moves from a multi-planet structure to a single transforming destination view and named categories. [15]
Online/Community affordances today	Operationally high, even when the UI is unchanged	The official servers are no longer available, creating a mismatch between historical interface and current service reality. [18][24]

9.3 Fast lookup: where did a feature go?

Question	Best answer
“Where is Global Stuff in the first game?”	In LBP1, global level settings were placed in the Tools Bag; later games organize Global Stuff separately. [9]
“Why does LBP2’s Popit look flatter than LBP1?”	LBP2 deliberately changes toward flatter, brighter colors, animated icons and color-matched button-hint boxes. [3]
“Is the PSP Popit just LBP1 shrunk down?”	No. It retains categories, but its controls/help and overall game content are adapted for the portable system. [4][5]
“Why is Vita green / why does its camera feel different?”	The default Popit palette is reported as green, and the Vita combines the right stick with the rear touch pad for camera work. [6][8]
“Why does Karting’s Popit have path and HUD tools?”	It is a racing-course/arena editor; its content authoring problems differ from platform levels. [13][14]
“Is Sackpocket another Popit page?”	No. It is a separate five-slot power-up radial inventory in LBP3. [17]
“Why is Community/Dive In visible but not working in LBP3 now?”	The official PS4 servers were taken offline indefinitely; locally stored and offline features remain. [18]

10. Visual reference index

The following references are useful for visual comparison. They are linked rather than reproduced as full-page images in this report. Some are editorial screenshots or specialist galleries; treat them as representative examples rather than a canonical frame for every regional version, menu state or patch.

Reference	What to inspect	URL
Original-era Popit material palette	Rounded page, selected material title, swatch grid and page indicators.	https://louisemclennan.wordpress.com/2016/11/30/top-5-favourite-video-game-interfaces/
LBP3 Popit customization screenshot	Character customization screen, option icons and close prompt.	https://www.player.one/littlebigplanet-3-mediocre-until-community-makes-it-better-397985
LBP3 creation panels	Materials and tools/used objects panels; swatches, section labels and scrolling.	https://www.playground.ru/gallery/littlebigplanet_3/
LBP2 SackBot tweak panel	Vertical property list, highlighted property and directional adjustments.	https://multiplayer.it/recensioni/84190-littlebigplanet-2-il-ritorno-del-ragazzo-di-pezza.html
Vita-era Community screen	Globe-centered navigation and green pill-like destinations; this is hub UI, not Popit.	https://gamesdb.launchbox-app.com/games/images/12104-littlebigplanet-ps-vita
Official LBP3 2016 Community UI announcement	The single-planet navigation change and Play/Create/Community/Profile/Store organization.	https://blog.playstation.com/archive/2016/08/15/littlebigplanet-3-gets-major-ui-update-new-level-kit-and-mm-anniversary-pack
Karting editor guide	Popit Cursor controls, Play/Create transitions, Moon/Earth and tutorials.	https://primagames.com/eguides/little-big-planet-karting-eguide/essentials/create-mode/basics

11. Popit geometry, motion and menu-state transitions

This section describes the shape language of the interface as well as what moves. “Shape” is used in three separate senses: (a) the silhouette and panel geometry of the Popit screen; (b) the small geometric symbols and selection affordances used by the UI; and (c) the in-world Popit Cursor / selection reticle used to manipulate creations. These should not be conflated. The asset archives explicitly separate Popit page imagery, Popit colour bubbles, shape icons, tool icons and cursor artwork. [26]

11.1 Surface geometry: the Popit panel itself

Version / surface	Panel silhouette and layout	Selection / page geometry	What the geometry communicates
LBP1 PS3	Glossy, soft-edged and translucent panels; a strong rounded-rectangle / bubble-like visual language. Customization can present tall inventory panels with a selected item shown larger and a row/grid of swatches or objects below.	Page arrows at panel edges and small page dots indicate more inventory. Category iconography is comparatively static. Prompt treatment feels soft/cloud-like, with dark lettering. [1][3][20]	The menu is a tactile object attached to the Sackperson and the handmade world, not a conventional flat pause overlay.
LBP PSP	Keeps the console-family Popit concept but compresses it into the PSP display and input model. Tutorials describe a sequence of menu icons and paged wardrobe screens, navigated using the analog stick, page buttons, Action and Back. [5][12][30]	Page changes are an explicit navigation concept; the tutorial tells the player to use page buttons to jump between wardrobe pages. Exact panel corner radii and animation timing are not established by the sources reviewed.	The information architecture is preserved; the implementation is adapted to a small handheld screen and one analog stick.

Version / surface	Panel silhouette and layout	Selection / page geometry	What the geometry communicates
LBP2 PS3	A visibly flatter, brighter and more saturated UI. Panels use stronger color blocks and cleaner icon fields; screenshots show stacked/translucent cyan panels, green category headings, a selected-item label and swatch grid. Icons are described as animated rather than static. [3][20]	Button prompts sit in smooth boxes keyed to the active player's Popit color. Multiple related panels can be visible at once (for example, Materials and Tools/Used Objects).	More visual motion and higher contrast turn the menu into a faster tool browser for a much larger creation system.
LBP Vita	A handheld-first layout with touch-centric visual affordances. The default Popit palette is documented as green in specialist comparison material; separate on-screen touch controls, a reduced thermometer and screen-edge controls are part of the wider Vita UI. [6][7]	Inventory is scrolled by dragging or flicking; a tap equips/selects; Back is pressed again to close the Popit. Tool icons and button hints have to coexist with direct touch targets. [31]	The menu must work under both button navigation and finger input; list motion becomes a direct manipulation gesture.
LBP Karting	A tall, dark translucent card with a vivid neon-green outer edge and a strong selected tile, photographed in a kart customization context. The highlighted selection is connected to a green beam / pointer reaching into the 3D Pod space. [32]	L1/R1 page navigation and a More prompt are visible in the screenshot reference; the grid emphasizes swappable part thumbnails. A Close Popit prompt sits separately at the bottom-left of the screen.	The menu behaves like a wardrobe / parts terminal within a racing garage; the beam makes the current selection legible against the 3D backdrop.
LBP3 PS3/PS4	The creation interface uses larger cyan/teal panels, green category bars, a clearly marked selected material, repeated thumbnail swatches, and lines that visually associate the UI with the active character or object. [33]	More prompts, page indicators and multiple simultaneous information panels make the toolset feel layered rather than radial. The panel can show several character and inventory contexts at once.	The UI becomes a richer authoring dashboard while keeping the playful craft materials and player-color accents.
LBP3 2016 Pod Computer	Not a Popit skin change. The Community / Pod Computer navigation surface replaces the older collection of multiple planet views with one planet that morphs as the player scrolls among destination categories. [15]	The named tabs become Play, Create, Community, All About Me and Store, with My Friends and Dive In as visible quick-access paths in the official screenshot. [15] [34]	This is a change in navigation architecture, not evidence that the in-level Popit was wholly replaced.

11.2 Geometric symbols inside the Popit

The Popit is not itself literally a circle/square/triangle menu. The archived UI asset catalogue includes separate "UI Popit Shape Circle", "UI Popit Shape Square" and "UI Popit Shape Triangle" artwork, alongside player-colour bubbles, colour-splat imagery, category/page icons, lock states, tutorial and warning markers, and the Popit Cursor artwork. This inventory establishes a set of reusable geometric symbols within the UI, but does not by itself prove that every game presents all three shape selectors in the same menu or context. [26]

Visual unit	Observed / documented role	Version comparison rule
Circle / square / triangle icon set	Named UI assets in the original PS3 Popit asset category. Distinguish the small symbol from the overall panel silhouette. [26]	Use only for the title/mode where the icon appears; do not infer universal availability.
Colour bubbles / colour splats	Player-colour identity and paint/material-related selection imagery; there are multiple numbered variants in the asset archive. [26]	Palette roles differ across LBP1, LBP2, Vita and LBP3; the same hue is not proof of the same function. [8]
Rounded panel / pill / tab	Main inventory surfaces, highlighted prompts and category labels. LBP1 is glossier; LBP2 onward generally favors flatter blocks and clearer color coding. [3]	Compare surface material, border treatment, selected state, labels and pagination separately.

Visual unit	Observed / documented role	Version comparison rule
Cursor / reticle / selection preview	A separate Create Mode interaction layer that selects and transforms objects in the world. It is not the same thing as the icon for opening Popit Cursor. [10][26]	Record whether the cursor is a browse focus, an in-world placement preview, or a selected-object transform state.
Page dots, arrows and More prompt	Signals the inventory continues beyond the visible set. More can expose another layer of choices rather than placing an item immediately. [1][32]	Do not read a page arrow as a game-world direction; it is menu pagination.

11.3 Motion: opening, browsing, selecting and manipulating

Motion phase	LBP1 / early grammar	Later development	Research note
Open Popit	The licensed guide says pressing Square makes it literally “pop” into the air above the Sackperson. The wording establishes a character-relative pop-up motion, not an exact frame count. [1]	Later releases retain the Popit metaphor but alter panel layout and contextual information; exact duration and easing are not established by the sources reviewed.	The opening transition is part of the spatial metaphor: UI arrives where the player character is.
Move focus	Stick-driven movement across category icons, with a selected tile/label and page navigation. [1] [5]	LBP2 adds animated icons and player-color-matched prompt boxes; later information bubbles may appear when hovering. [3][10]	Focus motion, hover text, and the actual action after confirmation are separate states.
Browse a collection	Wardrobe/materials use visible grids, left/right page arrows and page dots; selection can be tried on and removed. [1]	Vita directly supports drag/flick list navigation, tapping an item, and flicking again to stop; shoulder/page navigation remains available. [31]	On Vita, list inertia/flicking is interaction, not decorative animation.
Place / manipulate	A chosen object or sticker transitions to placement in the 3D layered world; the player can move it before committing. [1][5][10]	Later cursor features include scaling, rotation, depth/layer changes, object duplication, glue/unglue, capture, hide/show and more specialized edit operations. [10]	World-space motion should not be described as Popit panel animation.
Planet selection	Player moves through a set of planet/moon destinations from the Pod computer.	LBP2 is reported to zoom the camera toward the planets for navigation visibility; LBP3’s 2016 UI changes planet selection into a single destination view that morphs while navigating. [27][15]	Camera framing and the menu’s destination morph are distinct from the in-level Popit opening animation.
Karting selection	The chosen part is presented as a highlighted thumbnail in the upright panel.	The screenshot shows a green beam/laser-like pointer linking the menu selection to the 3D Pod/kart-space. [32]	The beam is an in-world selection cue, not evidence that the core Popit moved into a radial menu.

Motion certainty boundary: this report does not invent millisecond durations, easing curves, rotation speeds, cursor interpolation values or per-patch animation changes. Those require side-by-side frame capture from the specific retail builds. The sources support the kinds of movement and state changes above, not exact numerical animation specifications.

12. Sound and tactile audio feedback

LittleBigPlanet’s interface is audiovisually tactile: actions that change the menu or a creation can receive short, material-like confirmations. To avoid inventing sound descriptions, this section separates three levels of evidence: (1) sound-file names visible in an asset collection; (2) the general interaction role suggested by the path/name; and (3) perceived tone, pitch, duration and timbre, which must be verified by listening to the actual file or gameplay capture. The Sounds Resource page for LBP3 includes 208 items and exposes numerous UI filenames under inherited

“lbp2/sound_effects/ui/popit/…” paths, alongside separate paint open/close files. That is evidence of structured UI sound assets, but not proof that each filename is used on every screen in every release. [28]

Cue family / observed filename examples	Likely UI event represented by the name	What can safely be concluded
Popit open / close and menu navigation	The common interaction grammar implies open, close, focus movement and category confirmation events. Asset catalogue shows explicit “circuit_board_open_01.wav”, “circuit_board_grid_move_01.wav” and “circuit_board_close_01.wav”. [28]	The audio bank includes discrete open, grid-move and close cues for at least a specialised Popit sub-interface. This does not prove these are the exact global open/close sounds of the entire menu.
Hide / unhide layers	“hide_layer_01.wav”, “hide_layer_02.wav”, “unhide_layer_01.wav”. [28]	Layer visibility changes have dedicated feedback assets; hide/unhide should be distinguished from delete/reset.
Place a note	“note_place_01.wav”, “note_place_02.wav”. [28]	The sound bank distinguishes an object-placement action for note objects; it may have alternate takes.
Sticker cutout	“sticker_cutout_01.wav”, “sticker_cutout_02.wav”. [28]	Sticker editing has dedicated sound assets; it is a distinct operation from applying/placing a sticker.
Vertex editing	“vertex_split_01.wav”. [28]	At least one geometry-edit operation has a named sound cue in the asset list.
Paint menu open / close	Separate paths include “dlc/move/sound_effects/ui/paint/open.wav” and “…/paint/close.wav”. [28]	Paint UI has its own open/close files. Do not assume these are used for every edition or platform.
SFX for kart-specific controls	Karting has creation tools for track/arena, path drawing/editing, terrain cleanup, kart changes and global clears. [14][20]	A function inventory is available; exact audible response for each Karting action still requires a direct sound-bank or gameplay confirmation.

12.1 Sound as state feedback, not just decoration

- **Open/close:** audio punctuates the boundary between the play field and a menu state. The visual pop-up and sound together tell the player that input focus has moved to the interface.
- **Move/highlight:** short repeated sounds can make discrete focus changes legible, especially where a list/grid moves one item at a time. The “grid_move” filename proves the existence of such a named event in one Popit sub-interface, not a universal cue mapping.
- **Commit/apply:** placement, sticker cutout and vertex-split filenames reveal semantic events for different edit operations. A useful reconstruction should not assign one generic “click” to every tool.
- **Refusal / unavailable action:** the reviewed asset names do not establish a single universal refusal beep. In a write-up, label a refusal only when the actual UI blocks a command, displays a warning or makes a state transition impossible; do not infer an error sound from a missing function.
- **Audio ownership:** because the LBP3 asset page contains paths under both LBP2 and LBP3 folders, do not attribute every file to an original LBP3 composition. The resource listing is evidence of reused/inherited assets, which is itself a version difference.

For an audio-complete archive, record each cue against a reproducible state: title + platform/build + mode + menu context + exact input + output filename or recording timestamp. Without that context, “the Popit sound” is too broad: opening, focus movement, paging, placement, sticker editing, layer visibility and closing may use different events.

13. Planets, moons and destination architecture by game

The planet-and-moon metaphor is the series’ spatial information architecture, not background decoration. A Pod frames destinations as hanging miniature worlds or globes covered in level markers. Because fan terminology can conflate destination names, the table separates each game’s room, destination and navigation model. PSP is an exception: its Pod is a main-menu section, not the console-style live hub. [27][29]

Game / era	Visible world-object model	Meaning / typical destination role	Interaction + differences
LittleBigPlanet PS3 (2008)	From the Pod: Craftworld / Earth, My Moon and InfoMoon are documented destinations; the Earth/Craftworld globe is the progression map with region/level patches. [27][29]	Craftworld/Earth = story progression and level worlds; My Moon = player-created levels; InfoMoon = player/social/progress/suggestion information (the exact items exposed vary with network and build).	The player uses the Pod Computer/controller to enter the destination and then navigates a planet/patch map. The planets are physical-looking objects seen through the Pod window; prompt text such as "Use Pod Computer" anchors the interaction to the room.
LittleBigPlanet PSP (2009)	The Pod is a main-menu area; the hub offers Earth, Community Moon, My Moon and Pod Section. [29][30]	Earth = story/DLC content; My Moon = the player's own created levels; Community Moon = other users' levels; Pod Section = avatar/profile/news/customization area.	The Pod does not perform the same central live-navigation role as the console series. The PSP main-menu option chooses the Pod, and the Pod itself is a customization/news space; use a PSP screenshot rather than assuming the console Pod Computer screen.
LittleBigPlanet 2 PS3 (2011)	The Pod returns with a destination view of Craftworld and My Moon; the camera is reported to zoom toward planets to improve visibility when menus are used. [27]	Story/Craftworld and player-authored Moon remain the two core mental models; other community/store destinations can be reached through the broader hub UI.	The Pod room receives a stronger themed environment, and its camera framing gives the destination globes more screen area when navigating. Pod decoration/theme is distinct from the Popit menu skin.
LittleBigPlanet PS Vita (2012)	A wider Pod; the computer is represented by a PS Vita-shaped device, and the player taps one of the three planets to access its destinations. [27]	The hub/community layer uses a large globe with green rounded labels such as My Queue, Downloads, Me, Friends, Cool Levels, Team Picks, Recent Activity and Search in the documented Community screenshot. [35]	Touch is part of navigation, and this interface should not be treated as a DualShock UI simply placed on a smaller screen. The cited green-label globe is a Community view, not a screenshot of the entire interior Pod room.
LittleBigPlanet Karting (2012)	The Pod is more circular/horizontal and players cannot freely walk around it as in mainline titles; a distinct Popit Computer "Me" path centers My Moon and My Earth. [27][13][14]	My Moon = unpublished/working race or arena levels held in vacant crater slots; My Earth = published levels shown for sharing. My Profile exposes activity; Decorate changes both celestial bodies; Tutorials explains track/arena tools. [13][14]	This is the essential missing case: Karting's Pod Computer is a dedicated navigation route into Moon/Earth authoring and community activity. It must not be folded into the LBP3 Community UI description.
LittleBigPlanet 3 launch-era (2014)	The older multi-planet / destination-based Pod Computer organization returns, with the familiar physical Pod room and character switching among Sackboy, OddSock, Toggle and Swoop. [15][27]	Play, Create, Community, store/profile destinations are organised across planet-style views, while My Moon and Earth anchor saved creations and shareable worlds.	The room and the Pod Computer information architecture are separate. A themed Pod room or imported decoration can change the background without changing the navigation model.
LittleBigPlanet 3 after the 15 August 2016 update	One single planet view replaces the previous multi-planet structure; as the player scrolls through the Pod Computer, the planet morphs into each destination. [15][34]	Top-level choices: Play, Create, Community, All About Me and Store. Create contains the player's Moon and decorations for Earth/Moon; Community foregrounds featured/recommended/busiest/newly published levels; pressing X opens deeper legacy menus. [15]	This is a real navigation redesign. It does not mean all old features vanished, nor that Popit's in-level panel was replaced. The official announcement explicitly says previous functionality remained accessible by an additional X action within each category.

13.1 Earth, Craftworld, My Moon, InfoMoon and Community Moon are not interchangeable

- **Earth / Craftworld:** a story/progression world map or a curated/public representation of levels. In Karting, "My Earth" specifically means the user's published/shareable level set, not the general story planet.
- **My Moon:** the personal creation workbench. In Karting, empty craters are level slots; selecting one leads to a level creation flow and a theme choice. In LBP3's redesigned Create tab, the player's Moon groups saved creations and creation entry points.
- **InfoMoon:** an early LBP1-specific social/progress destination as documented in Pod references. Do not rename it "Community Moon" just because both are secondary destinations.
- **Community Moon:** a PSP-specific destination for other users' levels. It is part of the PSP main-menu/Pod model and is not a synonym for a globe surface with Community labels in Vita or LBP3.

- **My Earth in Karting:** the published counterpart to My Moon. The Prima guide says publishing a level moves it onto My Earth for sharing; decorating either body is a separate customization action.
- **2016 LBP3 single-planet view:** a navigation animation that morphs one planet into destinations. The object is not literally the player's own Earth/Moon at every step; the source describes a view/transition metaphor, not a planet ownership model.

13.2 Pod decoration versus Pod Computer content

Pod stickers, decorations, themes and saved Pod states alter the room the player inhabits. They do not themselves define whether the computer opens Craftworld, My Moon, Community or a 2016 single-planet menu. A saved Pod is a reusable decoration state; the destination globe/planet menu is navigation. Karting is especially easy to misread because the horizontal/circular Pod model and its Popit Computer's Me → Moon/Earth route differ from the console Pod rooms. [22][27][13]

14. Screenshot atlas: Popit and Pod surface per version

This atlas pairs a Popit surface reference with a Pod / Pod Computer destination surface for every major version. The companion HTML visual atlas (`LittleBigPlanet_UI_Screenshot_Gallery.html`) displays source-hosted captures inline in a browser; the links below point to the same source images/pages. A small number of variants do not have a stable standalone Popit capture in the reviewed public-source set, so the page links the version-specific reference rather than mislabeling a PS3 image as a PSP capture. The HTML atlas therefore flags those gaps visibly. The diagrams in the report are analytical descriptions; where an image is not explicitly called a screenshot, it must not be treated as one.

Version	Popit surface screenshot/reference	Pod / hub surface screenshot/reference	What the paired surface demonstrates
LBP PS3 (2008)	Popit customization/materials capture — Louise McLennan interface analysis. [36]	Pod Computer with Sackperson and three hanging planetary destinations — RomStation gallery. [37]	Classic glossy wardrobe UI vs a diegetic Pod window with Earth and moons.
LBP PSP (2009)	Version-specific Popit function reference — PSP Popit page and tutorial transcript; the reviewed source does not expose a reliable standalone retail Popit screenshot. [30][5]	PSP Pod destinations — Earth, My Moon and Community Moon captures hosted on the PSP wiki. [29]	A handheld version whose Pod is a main-menu section rather than a console-equivalent computer.
LBP2 PS3 (2011)	Character/material/used-object panel screenshot — GameStop product gallery. [38]	Pod Computer interaction screenshot — Dailymotion frame showing the Pod room and planet view. [39]	Flat cyan/green tool panels and expanded categories beside a more zoomed Pod navigation environment.
LBP PS Vita (2012)	Character-customization screenshot — PlayStationTrophies gallery. [40]	Community destination globe screenshot — LaunchBox image gallery. [35]	Touch-centric item selection and the green-pill globe community information architecture.
LBP Karting (2012)	Kart parts / headgear Popit screenshot — GamesRadar preview. [32]	Karting Pod room reference — Imagisphere screenshot gallery; My Moon/My Earth destination flow in Prima's guide. [13][41]	Neon green outlined panel plus laser-like pointer; separate Me → My Moon/My Earth creation route.
LBP3 launch-era (2014)	LBP3 materials/tool inventory screenshot — Playground gallery, plus official manual gameplay UI reference. [33][42]	Pre-redesign Pod screenshot files in the LBP3 screenshot collection. [43]	Multi-panel creation UI and the older multi-planet navigation period.
LBP3 after the 2016 UI update	Popit remains a distinct in-level/create interface; the screenshot references above remain a Popit surface, not a screenshot of the new hub. [33][42]	Official PlayStation Blog screenshot of the single morphing-planet Community UI. [34]	Explicitly separates the major 2016 Pod Computer navigation redesign from Popit's in-level role.

14.1 How to use this screenshot atlas for exact comparison

- Use the Popit screenshot to identify panel silhouette, active category, selected-item treatment, page indicators, prompt placements and world-space pointer/cursor. Do not use a character-customization screen as evidence for Create Mode tool availability unless the selected mode is visible.
- Use the Pod screenshot to inspect room geometry, window/backdrop, computer prop, destination objects, planet labels, camera zoom and navigation entry points. The Pod room is not the Pod Computer's full information architecture.
- Compare the 2016 LBP3 redesign against a launch-era LBP3 Pod Computer screen, not against an LBP1 Pod screenshot or a user-decorated Pod room. Room decoration is a different axis from the computer's destination menu.
- For PSP, the atlas identifies the known screenshot gap instead of pretending the PS3 Popit screenshot is a PSP screen. The PSP tutorial/reference records the six Popit menu functions and five customization pages, but that is not a substitute for an actual frame capture.
- For the best archival record, capture the same operation in each retail build: open Popit, navigate one category, open customization, open Create Mode tools, enter Pod Computer, select Moon/Earth/Community, and capture the transition before and after selection. Add platform/build/patch and whether the server connection was available.

15. Conclusions

The Popit's identity survives because its central interaction grammar is stable: open a menu in the craft-world, browse a category, choose an item, and manipulate it in context. The main evolution is in how much that grammar can do and how clearly the interface explains it. LBP1 establishes a tactile, character-bound creative menu; PSP retains the grammar while adapting it to handheld input; LBP2 modernizes its visual language and increases the precision and breadth of Create Mode; Vita adds touch-aware interaction and handheld-specific constraints; Karting specializes the toolbox for tracks and arenas; LBP3 adds multi-character and diagnostic capabilities, then separately refactors the Pod Computer's destination navigation in 2016. [1][3][4][6][14][15][16]

The most reliable series-wide model is therefore a layered one: Popit for character-facing and creation actions; Popit Cursor for in-world manipulation; context/tweak menus for object properties; Start/Pause for level/session control; and Pod Computer for world/community navigation. Use that model to identify whether a change is visual, functional, contextual, platform-bound or caused by a retired online service.

For interface recreation, archival study or tooling, the implementation rule is simple: do not build one universal list of buttons and vary only the skin. Match the title, platform, mode, object context and service state. The same icon family can lead to different capabilities across releases, and the same capability may move or be renamed without being removed.

16. Source register and confidence notes

Bracketed citations throughout the report point to the following sources. Accessed 29 October 2026. Page titles and URLs are recorded so that a reader can independently verify the claims or inspect screenshots/updated documentation.

[1] Licensed guide sample: "The Popit Menu" (Pearson / BradyGames). Open source
Early PS3 Popit opening, controller interaction and character customization.
[2] Imagisphere, "Popit Menu." Open source
Cross-title menu categories, Tutorial differences and Global Stuff relocation; page flags itself as work in progress.
[3] LittleBigPlanet Wiki, "LittleBigPlanet 2" (visual UI comparison section). Open source
LBP1-to-LBP2 visual comparison: flat style, animated icons, prompt boxes, gadget redesign.
[4] PlayStation Blog, "LittleBigPlanet: Sack it to Me – 'PSP Goodness, Part 1' Edition," 9 October 2009. Open source
Official framing of the PSP title as a new adventure adapted for handheld; Popit/tool description.
[5] Imagisphere, "The Introduction (LittleBigPlanet PlayStation Portable)." Open source
PSP tutorial text for Popit navigation, wardrobe pages, stickers and controls.
[6] LittleBigPlanet Wiki, "LittleBigPlanet PS Vita Changes." Open source
Specific Vita differences: green Popit default, Pod framing, thermometer, touch materials, controls and Create Mode restrictions; community-maintained.

[7] Imagisphere, “LittleBigPlanet PS Vita.” Open source
Vita title overview and features later influencing LBP3; page flags itself as a work in progress.
[8] Imagisphere, “Player Color.” Open source
Palette functions and cross-version changes in color roles.
[9] Imagisphere, “Create Mode.” Open source
Popit sections, save/mode/view/snap distinctions and original tutorials/Global Stuff arrangement.
[10] Imagisphere, “Popit Cursor.” Open source
Command-level behavior, selection, transform, layer, glue, hover, hiding, diagnostic bubbles and title-specific function inventories.
[11] Imagisphere, “Goodies Bag.” Open source
Collected materials, objects, community objects and captured objects.
[12] LBP PSP Wiki, “Popit.” Open source
Six Create Mode menu categories on PSP; community reference.
[13] Prima Games, “Little Big Planet: Karting Guide – Create Mode Basics.” Open source
Karting’s My Moon/Earth, profile/tutorials, Popit Cursor and control behavior.
[14] Imagisphere, “Template:Navbox LBPK popit functions.” Open source
Karting function inventory including customization, track/arena edit, terrain and global controls; separates unreleased entries.
[15] PlayStation Blog, “LittleBigPlanet 3 gets major UI update,” 15 August 2016. Open source
Official source for the 2016 Pod Computer and Community UI redesign.
[16] Imagisphere, “LittleBigPlanet 2” and “LittleBigPlanet 3.” Open source 1 / Open source 2
Game scope, LBP2 legacy retention/reorganization, LBP3 expanded characters/layers and release information.
[17] Imagisphere, “Sackpocket.” Open source
LBP3 five-slot powerup menu, controls and character-use restrictions.
[18] PlayStation, “Support for games you can play online” / decommissioned server information. Open source
Official status statement for LBP3 PS4 online-service shutdown.
[19] LittleBigPlanet Wiki, “Popit Menu.” Open source
Personal, Retry and Pod-specific character selection distinctions; community-maintained.
[20] Imagisphere, “Category: User Interface Images.” Open source
Reference gallery categorizing interface imagery by title.
[21] Imagisphere, “LittleBigPlanet (PlayStation Portable)/Game updates.” Open source
PSP 2.05 update notes for object flipping and Front View.
[22] Imagisphere, “Save Pod Tool.” Open source
Pod decoration/save context and tool availability.
[23] LaunchBox Games Database, LittleBigPlanet PS Vita images. Open source
Illustrative Vita Community screen (hub, not Popit).
[24] Time Extension, “LittleBigPlanet 3 Servers Taken Offline ‘Indefinitely’,” 20 April 2024. Open source
Reporting on service shutdown; official Sony statement quoted and linked.
[25] LBP Union, “LittleBigPlanet Server Status Dashboard.” Open source
Community-server status and explanation; not an official Sony source
[26] Imagisphere, “Category: Popit Interface Images” and original PS3 Popit asset category. Open source 1 / Open source 2
Named Popit asset families, circle/square/triangle shape icons, colour bubbles/splats, page icons, tool and cursor imagery.
[27] LittleBigPlanet Wiki, “The Pod”; Giant Bomb, “Pod (Object).” Open source 1 / Open source 2
Pod room, destination planets/moons, camera zoom and title-specific Pod differences. Community-maintained references.
[28] The Sounds Resource, “Popit” (LittleBigPlanet 3, PS3 sound asset listing). Open source
UI audio filenames, including Popit sub-interface open/grid-move/close, layer hide/unhide, note placement, sticker cutout, vertex split and paint open/close.
[29] LBP PSP Wiki, “Pod”; image references for Earth, My Moon and Community Moon. Open source
PSP’s menu structure and screenshot captions for Earth, My Moon, Community Moon and Pod Section.
[30] LBP PSP Wiki / Imagisphere, “Popit” and PSP Introduction tutorial. Open source 1 / Open source 2
Six PSP Popit functions and controls / page navigation tutorial.
[31] Imagisphere, “Introduction (LittleBigPlanet PS Vita).” Open source
Vita touch gestures for Popit: drag, flick, tap, repeat Back to close.
[32] GamesRadar, “LittleBigPlanet Karting preview”; representative Popit screenshot. Open source
Karting character/kart customization panel geometry, More prompt, L1/R1 paging, green pointer beam and Close Popit prompt.
[33] Playground.ru, LittleBigPlanet 3 screenshot gallery. Open source
LBP3 creation materials/tools screenshot; representative, not canonical for every mode.
[34] PlayStation Blog, official image used with the 2016 LBP3 UI announcement. Open source
Screenshot of Play/Create/Community/All About Me/Store around the single morphing-planet Community UI.
[35] LaunchBox Games Database, LittleBigPlanet PS Vita images. Open source
Community globe screenshot with green destination pills; hub view, not the Popit.
[36] Louise McLennan, “My top 5 favourite video game interfaces,” screenshot of the original Popit customization panels. Open source
Representative original Popit materials/body selection screenshot.
[37] RomStation, LittleBigPlanet (PlayStation 3) screenshot album. Open source
Pod Computer prompt with the original three-planet backdrop.
[38] GameStop LittleBigPlanet 2 Special Edition product image gallery. Open source
LBP2 character/materials and tools/used objects interface screenshot.

[39] Dailymotion, "LBP2 Glitch: Create in Pod in LittleBigPlanet 2!!" Open source
Representative LBP2 Pod room and Pod Computer interaction screenshot.
[40] PlayStationTrophies, LittleBigPlanet PS Vita screenshot gallery. Open source
Vita customization view with screen-edge UI and item label.
[41] Imagisphere, LittleBigPlanet Karting screenshot category and Prima Games Karting guide. Open source 1 / Open source 2
Karting Pod reference gallery and My Moon/My Earth/Tutorials workflow.
[42] PlayStation online manual, LittleBigPlanet 3 PS4 screen guide. Open source
Retail LBP3 gameplay/HUD and Popit-related screen reference.
[43] Imagisphere, LittleBigPlanet 3 screenshot category. Open source
Pre-redesign-era Pod image files and LBP3 screenshot archive.

Confidence and limitations

- The official 2016 PlayStation Blog post is the highest-confidence source for the LBP3 hub redesign, and PlayStation's decommissioned-server page is the preferred source for current official-service availability. [15][18]
- The most granular Popit control details come from Imagisphere and fan-maintained LittleBigPlanet wikis. Some pages are explicitly marked work in progress; claims based on those pages are specific to the version named and should be checked against footage or the game build for pixel-level recreation. [2][7][10]
- Visual references in Sections 10 and 14 are examples, not a claim that every version uses one invariant layout. Regional language, player-color choice, game mode, DLC, patch and context can change labels or panel content.
- The local Word/PDF cannot fetch source-hosted web screenshots in this network-isolated document-building environment. The accompanying HTML atlas embeds the known source image URLs for browser display and links to source pages; any missing/uncertain image is explicitly labelled. This is preferable to embedding fabricated images or relabelling another platform's screen.
- No unsupported exact coordinates, animation durations, sound pitch/duration values, hidden beta-only placements, or exhaustive per-patch image diffs are asserted. The document is comprehensive at the system and functional-inventory level, while transparent about evidence gaps at pixel-perfect level.